

Please let the study team know if you need an interpreter.

PARTICIPANT INFORMATION SHEET



Te Whatu Ora
Health New Zealand
Te Toka Tumai Auckland

Butterfly Feasibility Study

Formal Study title:	Surgical Treatment of stage I – II endometriosis: The Butterfly Feasibility (open pilot) study
Protocol number:	3
Sponsor:	N/A
Lead Study Doctor:	Dr Jessica Dunning
Study Site:	Te Toka Tumai Auckland Hospital and Greenlane Surgical Unit
Contact phone number:	(09) 243 0898
Ethics committee ref.:	2025 FULL 24069

Taking part in this research is your choice.

You do not have to take part. If you choose not to take part or withdraw from the study, your normal care will not be affected.

- You will be given time to decide whether you want to take part in this study.
- The study team will discuss the study with you and answer any questions you have before you decide.
- You may talk to family, whānau, friends, or healthcare providers before you decide.
- If you have private medical insurance, you may wish to check whether this study will affect your cover.
- If you decide to take part, you will be asked to sign the Consent Form. You will also be given a copy of this information sheet and the signed consent.
- If you change your mind about taking part, you can withdraw from the study at any time by telling the study team.
- There may be no direct benefit to you from taking part in this study.
- There will be a separate surgical consent form.

Introduction

You are invited to take part in a research study exploring a surgical treatment for endometriosis. Endometriosis is a long-term condition where tissue similar to the lining of the uterus grows outside of it, often causing pain and other symptoms. This tissue commonly appears on pelvic surfaces and can be difficult to fully identify during surgery.

Endometriosis is often described in stages based on how much endometriosis is seen at surgery. The stage does not necessarily reflect how severe a person's symptoms are.

Stage I–II endometriosis is considered mild. It usually involves small patches of endometriosis on the thin lining that covers the organs inside the pelvis (called the peritoneum). These patches are most often found near organs such as the uterus, ovaries, and fallopian tubes.

Stage III–IV endometriosis is more severe. It can involve larger areas of endometriosis, deeper growths into nearby tissues, cysts on the ovaries, and scar tissue that can cause organs in the pelvis to stick together.

This study includes people with mild (stage I–II) endometriosis only. We are not studying Stage III–IV endometriosis as the surgical management is more extensive for that group of patients.

The study is testing whether a different surgical technique, called *posterior peritonectomy*, can improve pain relief and quality of life for patients with early stage endometriosis. This procedure involves removing more of the peritoneum (the thin tissue layer lining the pelvic area behind the uterus), even if it doesn't visibly show signs of endometriosis. This is because the peritoneum may have endometriosis which is too small to see with the naked eye. This extra tissue removed is about the size of your palm. In contrast, the standard approach only removes areas of the peritoneum where endometriosis is clearly seen. Peritoneum starts to regrow without endometriosis in 24 - 48 hours and is fully regrown over the next seven days.

We think that removing the extra margin of peritoneum may remove more microscopic endometriosis and therefore improve the pain outcomes following surgery.

Posterior peritonectomy is a commonly performed for more advanced endometriosis, so is not a new surgical procedure, just one that is not usually performed for earlier stage endometriosis.

What is the aim of this study?

You have read the participant information sheet about the study where you are randomised to receive standard treatment or full peritonectomy. You have opted not to take part in the randomised trial and so you will **not** receive a posterior peritonectomy.

However, if during your routine surgical treatment you are found to have stage I-II endometriosis we would like to follow you after your operation with questionnaires about your pain levels and quality of life to see if standard excisional treatment has been beneficial to you. This is called a prospective observational study.

What type of study is this?

You have chosen to take part in an observational study. This means you will not receive treatment as part of the study but instead answer questions about your postoperative pain and quality of life. You may also be asked to fill in a survey about your reasons for not wishing to proceed with the randomised trial.

How is the study designed?

Auckland & Greenlane Hospitals

This study is being run in New Zealand only at Te Whatu Ora - Te Toka Tumai Auckland Hospital and Greenlane Surgical Unit.

Around 40 Participants

About 40 people will take part in this observational study and all will be in New Zealand.

12 month in Study

You will be in this study for about 12 months.

4 sets of online questionnaires

You will be asked to fill in questionnaires at baseline (before your surgery) then 3, 6 and 12 months post op. These can be done online, over the phone or face to face.

How will I take part?

We will approach you for consent prior to your planned endometriosis surgery. Because you have declined to be part of the trial assessing the two different surgical techniques, you will simply receive 'standard surgical treatment'. If during your surgery you are found to have stage I-II endometriosis we would like to follow up postoperatively as outlined above to assess your pain and quality of life through standardised surveys.

Who can take part in the study?

To take part in this study you must:	
✓	Be a person with a uterus between 18 and 50 years old
✓	Be undergoing a laparoscopy for pelvic pain with suspected stage I-II endometriosis
✓	Have no previous surgical treatment for endometriosis (a diagnostic laparoscopy and biopsy are acceptable)
✓	Agree to take part in the study

You cannot take part in this study if you:	
✗	Have had a previous hysterectomy or bilateral oophorectomy
✗	Are pregnant
✗	Are presumed to have stage III-IV endometriosis before surgery

There are other criteria you must meet to be eligible for the study. The study team will discuss all of them with you to make sure you are able to take part.

What will taking part in the study involve?

Screening (1-7 days)

If you decide to take part, you will be asked to sign the consent section at the end of this form.

The study team will then check whether you meet all the criteria to take part. This is called Screening.

- Screening must be done prior to surgery.
- It may be done on a single day or over several days.
- You will be told if you can take part once all your results have been checked.

Intervention and Follow-up (12 months)

You will be asked to complete online questionnaires before your surgery. If you are found to have stage I-II endometriosis, or no endometriosis, you will also be asked to complete online questionnaires at 3, 6, and 12 months. These will be emailed to you. If you are unable to complete these online our research nurse can call you to do the questionnaires over the phone or meet you and do them face-to-face.

After surgery, the 3-month post-operative visit will involve a face-to-face or online consultation as well as completion of the questionnaires.

At each visit you will have some of the assessments listed on the next page.

The table on the next page gives a summary of what will happen.

If your study doctor identifies any significant abnormal results during the study, they will tell your GP.

Early withdrawal

If you decide you want to withdraw from the study, please let us know. At the point you withdraw you will be asked if you consent for the use of any data collected prior to the point of your withdrawal. You may at this time withdraw your consent for any of your data to be used.

Study Assessments

Informed consent	You will read and sign an informed consent form before you take part.
Eligibility check	We will check that you qualify for the study.
History and demographics	We will review your medical and surgical history, pregnancy history and plans, medications and lifestyle choices relevant to the study and record your age, gender, and ethnicity.
Vital signs	We will record your pulse rate, breathing rate, temperature, blood pressure, blood oxygen levels.
Height and weight	We will check your height and weight.
Questionnaires	You will fill in some questionnaires about pain, mental wellbeing, medication use, activity, and quality of life. These questions will be answered on an electronic device. You will learn how to use it during screening. If you don't have access to a computer we can arrange for the research nurse to meet with you and help you fill in the online forms.
Physical examination	As part of routine care you may be examined by your doctor before surgery. The study does not involve any additional examinations to what would be involved if you did not take part in the study. During your post surgical 3 month review your belly may be examined to check for healing and pain – this is routine postoperative care and isn't any different if you agree to this study.
Health and Medication Check	We will ask you about any changes in your health and any changes to your medications. This includes prescription and over-the-counter medications, herbal or homeopathic remedies, and nutritional supplements.
Phone call	The study team will contact you to remind you to complete questionnaires if necessary.

Study Visits

Study Visit	Initial clinic appointment	Consent appointment – phone, online or face to face	3 month post-op questionnaire - online	6 month post-op questionnaire - online	12 month post op questionnaire – online or face to face
Time needed	30 min	30 min	15 min	15 min	15 min
Informed consent		x			
Eligibility check	x				
History & demographics	x				
Vital signs	x				
Height and weight	x				
Physical exam	x				
Pregnancy test					
Health & Medication Check	x				
Questionnaire(s)		x	x	x	x

What are my responsibilities during the study?

You should:	
✓	Complete online questionnaires before your surgery and (if required) at 3, 6, and 12 months after
✓	Tell a member of the study team if you have questions, comments, or decide you no longer wish to take part in the study
✓	Tell a member of the study team if your address or contact details has changed so we can continue to contact you.

What are the possible benefits of the study?

You will not get any direct benefit from being in the study. However, your participation will help future patients by improving knowledge about surgical options for early-stage endometriosis.

What are the possible risks of the study?

The questionnaires you are asked to fill in have questions about your mental health. Although the questionnaires you will fill in are not designed to detect serious mental health risk, we acknowledge they may bring up thoughts or feelings of concern for you.

If significant mental health and wellbeing concerns are raised in the answers you give in the questionnaires, we will contact you to offer support. We may also need to inform your emergency contact or GP and we will refer you to the Urgent Response Team if required. If we can't contact you we will be required to inform your GP. Contact details for the Urgent Response Team will be provided on all questionnaires.

We will also offer you a referral through to the women's health psychology team and to the multi-disciplinary pain service if required.

Will any costs be reimbursed?

There are no costs associated with taking part in this study, nor will you be paid.

You will receive a koha (a gift) after completing the surveys at 3, 6, and 12 months.

What if something goes wrong?

If you were injured in this study, you would be eligible **to apply** for compensation from ACC just as you would be if you were injured in an accident at work or at home. This does not mean that your claim will automatically be accepted. You will have to lodge a claim with ACC, which may take some time to assess. If your claim is accepted, you will receive funding to assist in your recovery.

If you have private health or life insurance, you may wish to check with your insurer that taking part in this study won't affect your cover.

What will happen to my information?

We will collect information ('data') about you and your study participation. If needed, information from your hospital records and your GP may also be collected. We only collect information needed for the study, to contact you or identify your medical

records. You cannot take part in the study if you do not want us to collect any of this information.

Identifiable information – <i>this information traces directly to you.</i>	
Examples?	Information carrying your name, birthdate, contact details, NHI number and ethnicity.
How is it stored?	Electronic: on secure University of Auckland servers
Who has access?	- Local study staff and health services that do your study assessments - Your GP / usual doctor [if needed] - Study monitors, to make sure data is collected properly - Study auditors (see below)
How long is it kept?	For at least 10 years

Coded information – <i>this information is labeled only with your unique study ID</i>	
Examples?	Your gynaecologic history, endometriosis stage, your surgical note and any complications that occur, any further treatment in the next 12 months and your questionnaire responses
How is it stored?	On a secure electronic server that complies with New Zealand data security guidelines.
Who has access?	The research team within the University of Auckland.
How long is it kept?	For at least 10 years

Anonymous information – <i>this information can not be linked to you in anyway</i>	
What is this?	Anonymised data will be irreversibly stripped of any identifying information
What does this mean	Anonymised data may be sent overseas for the purposes of contributing to pooled research outcomes (individual patient meta-analysis). There is unlikely to be New Zealand representation on overseas governance committees. Whilst the data can not be linked to you in any way we understand that this may raise cultural concerns for some participants.

Extra information about my data

Dr Jessica Dunning may need to share your identifiable information in the rare event of a serious threat to public health or safety, or to the life or health of you or another person, OR if the information is required in certain legal situations.

Audits: The study may be audited. Audits make sure studies are being carried out properly. Auditors need access to your identifiable study data and relevant health records to do this.. The Sponsor, NZ or overseas regulatory agencies, or the approving Ethics Committee may do audits.

Data Access: You have the right to request access to information about you held by the research team, including the results of tests and procedures. You also have the right to request that any information you disagree with be corrected.

Study Withdrawal: You can ask the study team to stop collecting information about you at any time. This will end your participation in the study. Information collected up until this point will continue to be used, to protect the quality of the study.

Data Storage: After the study, your identifiable data will be stored for at least 10 years in a secure storage facility. Your coded data will be stored indefinitely on secure electronic servers. All storage will comply with local and/or international data security guidelines.

Data Risks

Although efforts will be made to protect your privacy, absolute confidentiality cannot be guaranteed. There is a risk that people may access or use your information in ways that you may not be acceptable to you.

Data sent overseas will be governed by overseas laws. These may not give as much protection as New Zealand laws.

Māori Data

We recognise Māori data is a tāonga. Māori data sovereignty permits Māori organisations to access coded Māori data, to support Māori development aspirations. There is an understanding that Māori data are tapu and therefore to be respected and handled appropriately.

Could the study end earlier than planned for me?

If you wish to withdraw from the study, please let us know. We may ask if you could complete some end-of-study assessments if you withdraw early.

We may withdraw you from the study if we believe it is not in your best interests to continue. We will discuss any withdrawal decisions with you and provide health care advice where appropriate.

Other reasons that you may be withdrawn from the study are:

- The study is stopped
- You have a serious reaction or illness or injury that is not related to the study.

Can I find out the results of the study?

Information relating to this study, such as a summary of results, will be available on the Australian New Zealand Clinical Trials Registry (ANZCTR).

You can choose to be sent a copy of the study results once the study is over. You can select this in the consent form below.

Who is funding the study?

This study is being funded by contestable grants.

You will not have rights to ownership or benefit financially.

The University of Auckland will receive payment from donor organisations for conducting this research. The study team members will only receive their ordinary wages for conducting this research.

Who has approved this study?

This study has been approved by an independent group of people called a Health and Disability Ethics Committee (HDEC), who check that studies meet established ethical standards. The Central HDEC has approved this study.

The scientific aspects of this study have been approved by the Standing Committee on Therapeutic Trials (SCOTT).

Who do I contact for more information?

If you have any questions, concerns or complaints about the study at any stage, you can contact:

Dr Jessica Dunning – Principal Investigator
(09) 243 0898
jessica@butterflystudies.nz

If you want to talk to someone who isn't involved with the study, you can contact an independent health and disability advocate on:

Phone: 0800 555 050
Fax: 0800 2 SUPPORT (0800 2787 7678)
Email: advocacy@advocacy.org.nz
Website: <https://www.advocacy.org.nz/>

For Māori cultural support please contact:

He Kamaka Waioira (Māori Health Team)
(09) 243 0898
briana@butterflystudies.nz

You can also contact the health and disability ethics committee (HDEC) that approved this study on:

Phone: 0800 400 569 (Ministry of Health general inquiries)

Email: hdec@health.govt.nz

CONSENT FORM

Butterfly Feasibility Study

Formal Study title:	Surgical Treatment of stage I – II endometriosis: The Butterfly Feasibility (open pilot) study
Protocol number:	3
Sponsor:	NA
Lead Study Doctor:	Dr Jessica Dunning
Contact phone number:	(09) 243 0898
Ethics committee ref.:	2025 FULL 24069
24-hour number:	(09) 243 0898

Please let your study doctor know if you need an interpreter.

I have read, or have had read to me, and I understand the Participant Information Sheet.

I have been given sufficient time to consider whether or not to take part in this study.

I have had the opportunity to use a legal representative, whānau/ family support or a friend to help me ask questions and understand the study.

I am satisfied with the answers I have been given regarding the study and I will be given a copy of this consent form and information sheet.

I understand that taking part in this study is voluntary (my choice) and that I may withdraw from the study at any time without this affecting my usual care.

I consent to the research staff collecting and processing my information, including information about my health.

If I decide to withdraw from the study, I consent for the information collected about me up to the point when I withdraw to continue to be processed.

Yes ☐

No ☐

I consent to my GP or current provider being informed about my participation in the study.

I consent to my GP or current provider being informed of any significant abnormal results obtained during the study.

I agree to an approved auditor appointed by the New Zealand Health and Disability Ethics Committees, or any relevant regulatory authority or their approved representative reviewing my relevant medical records for the sole purpose of checking the accuracy of the information recorded for the study.

I understand that my participation in this study is confidential and that no material, which could identify me personally, will be used in any reports on this study.

I understand the compensation provisions in case of injury during the study.

I know who to contact if I have any questions about the study in general.

I understand my responsibilities as a study participant.

I wish to receive a summary of the results from the study. Yes ☐ No ☐

Declaration by participant:

I hereby consent to take part in this study.

Participant's name:

Signature:

Date:

Declaration by member of research team:

I have given a verbal explanation of the research project to the participant, and have answered the participant's questions about it.

I believe that the participant understands the study and has given informed consent to participate.

Researcher's name:

Signature:

Date:
